

Four failure modes

context window

```
system: You are a coding agent. Work in the w...
user: Continue building todo.py.
tool_use run_tests: Smoke test before touchin..
run_tests result: ERROR: tests: 0 passed, 12 ...

tool_use write_file: save(item) typo in the h..

write_file result: wrote todo.py (77 lines)
tool_use run_tests: run_tests()
run_tests result: ERROR: tests: 7 passed, 5 f...
assistant: 7 of 12 passing again. Committing ...
```

622/1500 tok

■ system ■ user ■ assistant ■ tool call ■ tool result ■ hook ■ skill ■ summary

the disk (real files)

```
CLAUDE.md
init.sh
tests/test_todo.py
todo.py
feature_list.json 7/12 passing
```

✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗

```
git log
○○
59785ed
```

Smoke test at the start, commit at the end. The new commit dot is the only thing the next session inherits -- state stays clean.